

A

Ways of cooking food

You **boil** potatoes or rice in a **saucepan**.

You can **fry** sausages in a **frying pan**.

You **grill** toast or meat under a **grill**.

You **roast** meat [using oil] in the **oven**.

You also **bake** cakes [without oil] in the oven.

You **barbecue** meat and fish on a **barbecue**.

Food which is not cooked is **raw**.



B

Preparing and cooking food

Peel the potatoes [remove the skin] and boil them.

While they're boiling, **chop** an onion. [cut it into small pieces]

Fry the onion before **adding** some chopped tomatoes. [putting them together with the onions]

Then **stir** it all for a few minutes. [move it around in a saucepan using a spoon]

C

What does it taste like?

Chefs [people who cook food in a restaurant as a job] always **taste** the food [put a small amount in their mouth to see what it is like] while they are cooking.

I don't like the **taste** of too much garlic.

I tried the soup and it **tasted** a bit strange.

Michel's food is very **tasty** [has a good taste].

Indian food is a bit too **spicy** for me [with a strong hot flavour].

You get ice cream in different **flavours** [the type of taste that food or drink has, e.g. vanilla, coffee, strawberry, etc.].

Lena said her pasta was **horrible** [terrible, unpleasant], but I thought it was **delicious** [fantastic, with a wonderful taste].

Language help

We use the word **sour** to describe the taste of lemons (*opp* **sweet**), but usually **bitter** to describe coffee that is strong and has a sharp unpleasant taste (*opp* **smooth**). Strong, dark chocolate can also be described as bitter, but this is not always negative.

D

Are you a good cook?

“I'm a bit nervous when I cook, so I always follow a **recipe** [the cooking instructions for a particular dish, e.g. lasagne], and make sure I have all the right **ingredients** [the different food you need to make a particular meal] before I start. However, I am quite good at making **pies**, especially apple **pie**.” (Pie is pronounced /**paɪ**/ like ‘my’.)



apple pie

Common mistakes

A person who cooks well is a good **cook** (NOT a good ~~cooker~~). The **cooker** is the large piece of equipment you use for cooking. You could also say that you are **good/bad** at cooking (NOT good/bad ~~in~~ cooking), e.g. *I'm quite good at cooking fish*.

Also we ‘cook’ a type of food, e.g. *I'm cooking some beef*, but we ‘make’ a dish, e.g. *I'm making dessert*. (NOT *I'm ~~cooking~~ dessert*.)